

Question 23 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe training as an HRD subsystem and explain how it contributes to employee development.

Introduction

Training is a planned organisational effort to help employees learn job-related competencies — knowledge, skills and attitudes needed to perform work. One definition in the notes (Noe and others) is: a planned effort by the company to facilitate employees' learning of job-related competencies. Another simple idea is that training is offered especially when there is a performance deficiency that is due to lack of skill.

In HRD, training is one subsystem, not the whole of HRD. It contributes to development when it is based on real needs and when the workplace allows the new learning to be used. A picnic with a lecture is not a training subsystem.

Detailed points

- 1. Place of training in the HRD system.** Training receives its purpose from Training Needs Assessment and from appraisal gaps. It uses design (objectives, methods, resources) and delivery, then evaluation. People return to bosses, climate and career systems that must support transfer. Isolated training is an event; as a subsystem it is a link in a chain.
- 2. Contribution through knowledge, skill and attitude.** Employee development is not only 'knowing facts'. A customer officer needs product knowledge, listening skill, and an attitude of respect. Training that only lectures facts under-develops the person. Good training uses methods that match the type of learning: practice for skill, discussion for attitude, explanation for knowledge.
- 3. Contribution to present-job effectiveness.** When need = standard performance minus actual performance, and the cause is KSA, training raises proficiency, reduces errors and builds confidence. A machine operator trained on a new process produces more with fewer defects. Individual development here is visible in the current role.
- 4. Contribution to future roles and change.** New technology, laws, quality systems or a promotion require learning before the person fails in public. Combined with education (concepts, judgement), training prepares expected future roles — which is an HRD objective in T.V. Rao's definition. Development is then preventive, not only remedial.
- 5. Morale, satisfaction and employability.** Notes list benefits: higher job satisfaction and morale, motivation, lower turnover, better company image, capacity to adopt new methods. Being trained is a signal that the organisation invests in the person. That signal is itself developmental: the employee feels valued and stays to grow further.
- 6. Socialisation and culture.** Induction training develops understanding of the organisation's purpose, customers, rules and expected behaviour. New employees become members, not only job holders. This is development of the person-in-the-organisation, not only of a pair of hands.
- 7. Limits — so that contribution is not overstated.** Training cannot fix a broken machine, an impossible target, or a cruel boss. If climate is weak, contribution dies after the classroom. That is why training must remain a subsystem among appraisal, counselling and career. The notes also warn against off-the-shelf programmes and against treating training as the answer to all problems.
- 8. How to maximise its contribution to development.** Start with TNA; write clear objectives; choose suitable methods (on-the-job, off-the-job, e-learning); deliver well; involve the boss in transfer; evaluate learning, behaviour and results. Then training truly develops employees instead of entertaining them.

Conclusion. Describe training as planned learning of job competencies and as one HRD subsystem linked to needs and transfer. It contributes by building KSA for present and future work, morale, and socialisation — provided diagnosis is honest and the workplace supports use of learning. Training develops people; a training calendar alone

does not.